TASK A · L2 SUPPORT ENGINEER ASSESSMENT

Trading-holiday scraper

How it was built, every logical step it takes, what the live run produced and what it refuses to do

Live run	2026-10-16 11:31:01 UTC · overall validation WARN
Rows	60: NYSE 34, NASDAQ 12, OPRA 14, CME 0
Code	deliverables/taskA_holidays/scraper/ (Python 3.12), 11 offline tests
Automation	.github/workflows/trading-holidays.yml, weekly and on demand
Published to	Google Drive (four CSVs, uploaded by hand on 18 Oct) and the GitHub repository

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1. Summary

The task was to collect trading holidays and early closes for several US exchanges, normalise them into one schema with UTC times, validate them, and publish them to Google Drive automatically. I treated it as a small production job rather than a one-off script: every source was inspected before a parser was written, every response body is kept on disk, every adapter fails independently, and the validation step reports problems instead of quietly fixing them.

60	34	0	WARN	0
rows published	NYSE, 2026–2028	NYSE vs NASDAQ 2026 differences	overall validation	CME rows (by design)

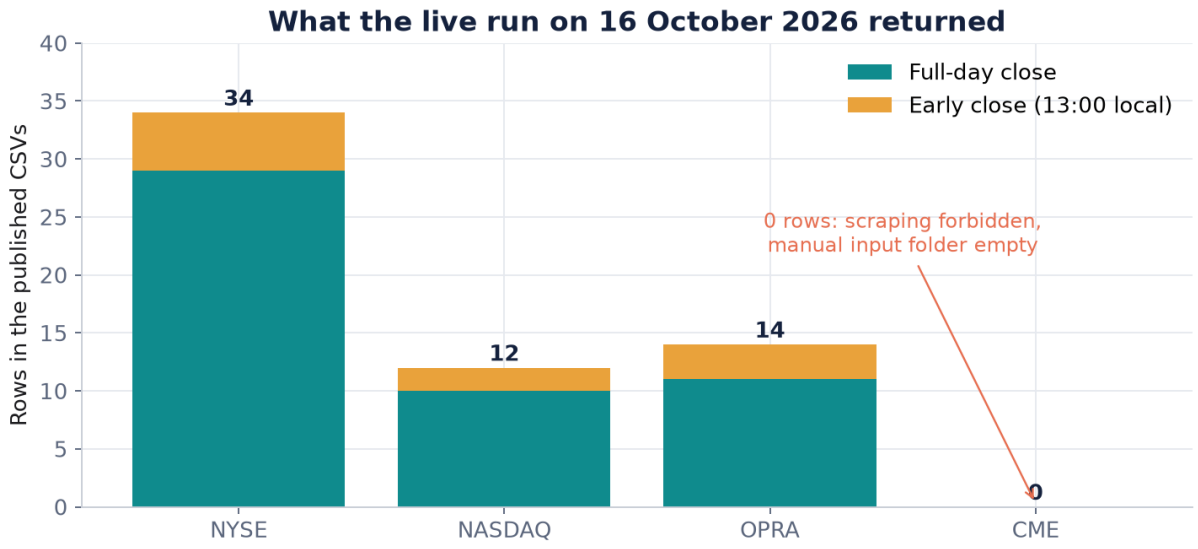


Figure 1. *Rows per exchange in the live run. CME is empty on purpose (see section 5.4).*

The result is WARN rather than PASS, and that is the right outcome. The equity calendars pass every check and agree with each other date for date. The warnings are the three things I could not legitimately fetch: CME (its terms forbid scraping), and OPRA having only a 2025 schedule online, so it shares no year with NYSE or NASDAQ for a cross-check.

2. The files on Google Drive

These four CSVs are the deliverable. The uploader finds each file by name and overwrites it, so a weekly run never creates duplicates. That is why the names must not change.

File	Contents	Rows	Size
trading_holidays_combined.csv	Every exchange in one table	60	16,229 B
trading_holidays_NYSE.csv	NYSE 2026–2028	34	9,092 B
trading_holidays_NASDAQ.csv	NASDAQ 2026 (only year published)	12	2,864 B
trading_holidays_OPRA.csv	OPRA, from the 2025 schedule PDF	14	4,579 B

Not uploaded: _previous_combined.csv (the baseline for the run-to-run diff), run_meta.json and upload_manifest.json (internal bookkeeping), and raw/ (evidence, not the calendar). When the Drive secrets are configured the job also builds one Google Sheet, trading_holidays, with a tab per exchange and a validation tab. The live run was a dry run; the four files above were uploaded by hand on 18 October, so the Drive API path itself is still unverified.

Column	Meaning
exchange	NYSE, NASDAQ, OPRA or CME
date	Session date, ISO format
holiday_name / canonical_name	Name as published / normalised name used for cross-exchange comparison
status	closed or early_close
close_time_local, timezone, close_time_utc	Early-close time in the exchange's zone and converted to UTC with zoneinfo (DST-correct)
session_or_product_scope	Which session or product the row applies to
source_url, scraped_at_utc, source_year	Provenance: where, when, and which year's publication

3. How the scraper works

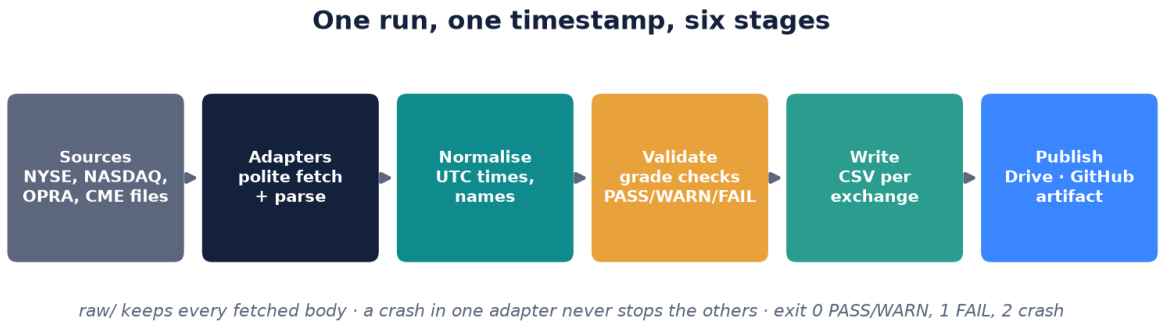


Figure 2. *The six stages of a run.*

There is one entry point, python -m scraper.run. It stamps a single UTC timestamp for the whole run (so a slow adapter cannot make one file look like two runs), calls the adapters in order, normalises the rows, validates them, writes the files and, if asked, uploads. The steps below follow that order.

Step 1: Reconnaissance before any parser

Each candidate source was opened once and saved under raw/_recon_2026-10-16/ before I trusted it. Two of the five obvious URLs turned out to be the wrong choice, which is exactly why this step exists.

Source	What I found	Decision
nyse.com hours-calendars	Static HTML table for 2026–2028; early closes only in footnotes	Scrape the HTML
nasdaq.com holiday page	Non-browser clients time out or get an HTTP/2 reset	Fallback only (Playwright)
nasdaqtrader.com Calendar	Official operations page, same 2026 table over plain HTTPS	Primary NASDAQ source
opraplan.com	Yearly holiday PDF linked from the homepage (theocc.com is the clearing house and returns 403)	Follow the PDF links
cmegroup.com	HTTP 403 even for robots.txt; Data Terms of Use prohibit scripts	Do not scrape; read operator files

Step 2: Fetch politely, keep everything

All adapters share one fetch method. It sends normal browser headers (to identify the client, not to evade anything), saves every 200 response under raw/<exchange>/<run>/, and treats status codes differently on purpose:

- **401, 403, 404:** saved with an .httpNNN suffix and raised immediately and never retried. A site that has said no is not asked again.
- **429 and 5xx:** wait for Retry-After if given, otherwise 2^attempt plus jitter, then retry.
- **Network errors:** retried the same way, except for NASDAQ, where a connection reset means 'this client is refused'; it gets two quick tries and moves to the next source.

Step 3: Parse each exchange

NYSE

The page has one table: holiday names down the side and one column per year. A cell with a date becomes a closed row for that year; a cell with a dash means 'not observed' and produces a note, not an invented date: New Year's Day 2028 falls on a Saturday and NYSE publishes a dash, so there is no row. Early closes are not in the table at all; they live in the footnotes ('...will close early at 1:00 p.m. on...'). The adapter keeps the footnote text, finds the time and the weekday dates in it, and turns each into an early_close row. Live result: 29 closes and 5 early closes across 2026–2028.

NASDAQ

nasdaqtrader.com is tried first, with short timeouts. Its table is 'year | Holiday | Status'; a status containing a time is an early close at that local time. If it fails, headless Chromium opens the public nasdaq.com page and the rendered HTML is parsed instead. No stealth plugins, no proxies. If both fail, NASDAQ ships zero rows with a SOURCE_UNAVAILABLE note and the other exchanges still publish. Live result: nasdaqtrader.com answered with 12 rows; the Playwright fallback is tested on a saved page but was not needed live.

OPRA

OPRA publishes one PDF per year, linked from its homepage. The adapter collects links whose text says 'holiday schedule' with a year from last year onwards, downloads them a second apart, and reads them with pdfplumber: 'HOLIDAY NAME Month D' lines are closes, and the asterisked footnote lists the 13:00

ET early closes. On 16 October only the 2025 PDF was linked (the 2026 URL returned 403), so OPRA ships 14 rows from 2025, including 1 January 2026 printed on the 2025 notice.

CME: the step that deliberately does not fetch

There is no single CME holiday calendar: equity index, rates, energy and agriculture differ, and Globex differs from ClearPort. The adapter is scoped to Globex US equity index products (ES, NQ, YM, RTY) and reads only files an operator has downloaded into input/cme/: a CSV in a documented format or the per-holiday PDFs. The folder was empty, so CME returned zero rows with a MANUAL_INPUT_REQUIRED note. Scraping a site whose terms forbid it is not a trade-off I would make for a client-facing job.

Step 4: Normalise

- Clean names (collapse whitespace, strip footnote marks) and map them to canonical names, so 'JUNTEENTH' in the OPRA PDF still matches 'Juneteenth' elsewhere.
- Convert early-close times to UTC using the exchange's IANA time zone: 13:00 New York on 24 December 2026 becomes 18:00Z (EST), on 3 July 2028 it becomes 17:00Z (EDT).
- Sort and drop duplicate (exchange, date, status) keys. There were none on this run.
- Trust the published date. An observed-date helper exists and is tested, but it is never used to invent a date the source did not print.

Step 5: Validate, without auto-correcting

Validation walks the table once and grades every check PASS, WARN or FAIL. The overall result is the worst grade. Differences between exchanges are reported, never edited away.

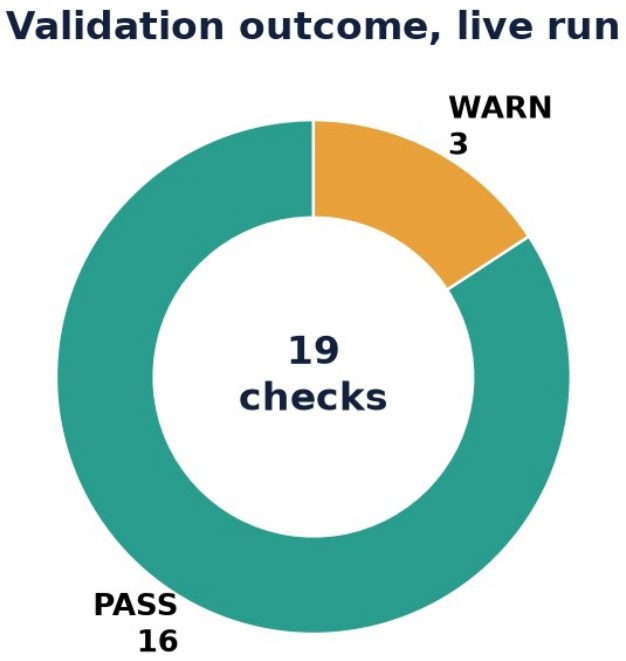


Figure 3. *Outcome of the live run's checks.*

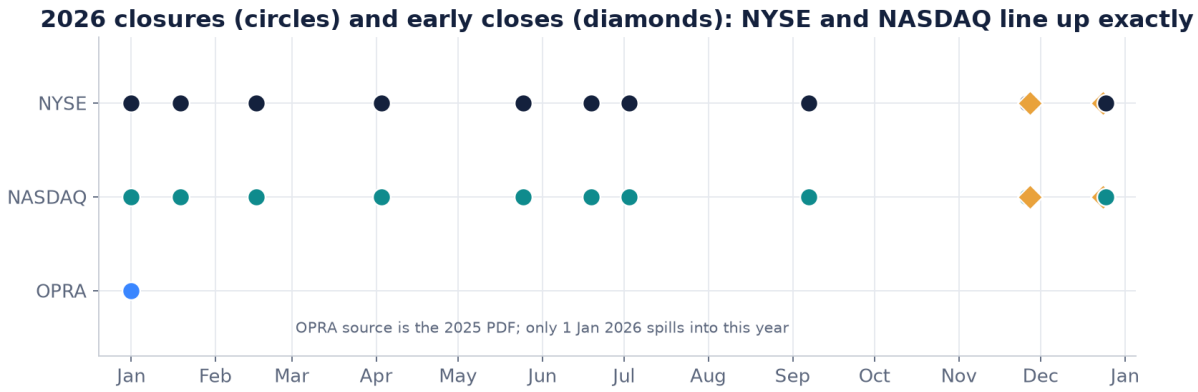


Figure 4. *NYSE and NASDAQ 2026 closures and early closes; the cross-check found 0 differing dates.*

Check	Result	Detail
NYSE.rows	PASS	NYSE returned 34 rows
NASDAQ.rows	PASS	NASDAQ returned 12 rows
OPRA.rows	PASS	OPRA returned 14 rows
CME.rows	WARN	CME returned 0 rows (manual input required, see notes)
weekday	PASS	0 weekend-dated rows
duplicates	PASS	0 duplicate (exchange,date,status) rows
NASDAQ.2026.closures	PASS	10 full-day closures (plausible 8-11)
NYSE.2026.closures	PASS	10 full-day closures (plausible 8-11)
NYSE.2027.closures	PASS	10 full-day closures (plausible 8-11)
NYSE.2028.closures	PASS	9 full-day closures (plausible 8-11)
OPRA.2025.closures	PASS	10 full-day closures (plausible 8-11)
OPRA.2026.closures	PASS	1 closure(s) spilling from source_year 2025
early_close_time	PASS	0 early-close rows without a close time
NYSE_vs_NASDAQ.closed	PASS	years [2026]: 0 differing dates
NYSE_vs_NASDAQ.early_close	PASS	years [2026]: 0 differing dates
NYSE_vs_OPRA	WARN	no overlapping source years ([2026, 2027, 2028] vs [2025]); comparison skipped
NASDAQ_vs_OPRA	WARN	no overlapping source years ([2026] vs [2025]); comparison skipped
good_friday	PASS	5 Good Friday rows checked against Easter-2
diff_previous	PASS	rows 60 -> 60 (0.0% change, threshold 30.0%); added 0: []; removed 0: []

New check. After an external review I added one more check: every full NYSE and NASDAQ year must contain at least one early close. Footnote parsing is the fragile part of the NYSE adapter, and a layout change that silently yields zero early closes would otherwise pass. Applied to the saved run it gives:

Check	Result	Detail
NASDAQ.2026.early_closes	PASS	2 early close(s); minimum 1
NYSE.2026.early_closes	PASS	2 early close(s); minimum 1
NYSE.2027.early_closes	PASS	1 early close(s); minimum 1
NYSE.2028.early_closes	PASS	2 early close(s); minimum 1

Step 6: Write the files and exit with a meaningful code

The combined CSV and one CSV per exchange that returned rows are written (CME has no file because it has no rows), plus validation_report.md, validation_checks.json and run_meta.json. Before overwriting, the previous combined file is copied aside so the next run can diff against it; a change of more than 30 % of rows is a FAIL. Exit code 0 means PASS or WARN, 1 means validation FAIL, 2 means an adapter crashed, and the automation treats those differently.

4. Automation on GitHub

The workflow lives at .github/workflows/trading-holidays.yml in the repository root, the only place GitHub executes workflows from.

1. **Triggers.** Every Monday at 06:17 UTC, plus a manual run with an exchange list and an upload switch.
2. **Setup.** Python 3.12, requirements.txt and Playwright's Chromium for the NASDAQ fallback.
3. **Tests first.** python -m pytest tests -q runs 11 tests on saved fixtures, no network.
4. **Run with retries that make sense.** Up to three attempts with backoff for a crash (exit 2); a validation FAIL (exit 1) stops immediately because retrying will not fix a bad calendar.
5. **Report.** The validation report goes into the run summary; output/ and raw/ are kept as a 90-day artifact.
6. **Publish.** With the Drive secrets set the files are uploaded; without them the job runs in DRY_RUN. The refreshed CSVs are committed back to the repository, skipping missing files and empty commits.
7. **Alert.** On failure, a Slack message with the run link and the FAIL/WARN lines, if SLACK_WEBHOOK_URL is set.

Secret	Purpose	Required
GOOGLE_SERVICE_ACCOUNT_JSON	Service-account key content for the Drive API	For upload
GDRIVE_FOLDER_ID	Target folder; empty means DRY_RUN	For upload
SLACK_WEBHOOK_URL	Failure alerts	Optional
GDRIVE_SHARE_WITH (variable)	Comma-separated readers to share with	Optional

What 'fetch everything' can and cannot mean

The job fetches NYSE, NASDAQ and every OPRA PDF linked from opraplan.com. It does not fetch CME and it does not invent an OPRA 2026 calendar; CME appears automatically once an operator places its files in input/cme/.

5. What was not done, and why

Item	Status	Why
Drive upload through the API	Partial	No service account in this environment; files uploaded by hand, API path unverified
CME rows	Not done	cmegroup.com returns 403 and its terms forbid scraping; manual input required
OPRA 2026	Blocked	Not published yet; the 2026 PDF URL returned 403
nasdaq.com via Playwright, live	Partial	Tested on a saved page; not needed live
Cross-check with a third-party holiday library	Not done	Considered; the NYSE–NASDAQ cross-check already covers 2026

6. Adding another exchange

1. Create scraper/adapters/<name>.py with the exchange, time zone, source URL and scope, implementing scrape() and parse().
2. Use self.fetch so raw bodies are kept, and self.row(...) so the schema stays aligned.
3. Register it in scraper/adapters/__init__.py and give it a plausible closure band in validate.PLAUSIBLE_CLOSURES.
4. Save a fixture under tests/fixtures/ and add an offline parser test.
5. Add the name to the workflow's default exchange list.